

7-0 (A)

COLORADO RARE BIRD REPORT

Red 2/2/01 upl

PROTHONOTARY WARBLERProtonotaria citreaLocation: Woodlot/grove at 16 and JJ Rds.; near Lamar, Bent County, ColoradoDate: October 8, 2000Setting:

This bird was first found and reported (on October 7th?) by Ira Sanders.

Brandon Percival and I observed this bird in the wood lot on the North side of JJ Road. It flew to me in the heaviest part of the grove. It sat quietly and still in full view for about 5 minutes; but also foraged low to the ground and on the ground by probing/flipping leaves, in the most tangled part of this grove.

Description:

It was an adult male. It was a plump, heavy-bodied warbler with distinctive plumage: The wings and tail were slate blue-gray. There were no wingbars. The back was grayish-yellow. The head and underparts were bright, clear, deep yellow with even deeper yellow on the forecrown and forehead. The bill was sharp and longish, black. The eye was black. The undertail coverts were gleaming white. Legs were black.

Similar Species:

The only other mainly yellow-headed warblers are: Blue-winged (wingbars; black eye-line); Orange-crowned and Tennessee (lack blue-gray wings and tails); Yellow (streaked below; lacks blue-gray wings and tail; has yellow undertail coverts); and Wilson's (smaller; lacks white undertail coverts; has tiny bill).

Experience with Species:

I have seen all the warblers mentioned above. I've seen several Prothonotary Warblers previously in Colorado and quite a few in other parts of the country.

This report is prepared from notes made at the time of observation.

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